

ANCIENT ORDER OF FREE GARDENERS

The Comprehensive Catechism

From Apprentice to Master Gardener

A **catechism** is a structured series of questions and answers designed to teach core ideas in a clear, memorable way. In our Order, it serves as both an educational tool and a shared language, helping members understand the symbolism, values, and purpose of the organization. Because it is simple, direct, and easy to recite, a catechism can be used to instruct new members, reinforce lessons for seasoned members, and even introduce non-members to the Order's philosophy. It becomes a unifying method of passing down tradition, ensuring that teachings remain consistent, accessible, and meaningful across generations.

The following is a comprehensive catechism of the Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, which is a summarized version of the Catechism found in the degree ceremonies:

What is Free Gardening?

Free Gardening is the mindful care of the soil, understood as a metaphor for cultivating one's own mind, spirit, and virtues.

What is a Free Gardener?

A Free Gardener is someone who seeks to create a "paradise garden" within themselves. They view the garden as a spiritual path toward self-knowledge and personal growth.

What is the task of a Free Gardener?

A Free Gardener envisions (Atziluth), develops (Beriah), shapes (Yetzirah), and creates (Assiah) a metaphorical garden that ultimately represents their own inner self.

What is the attitude of Free Gardeners?

Their outlook is rooted in a deep love for the Creator, creation, nature, and humanity, expressed through the virtues of Love, Wisdom, Harmony, and Truth.

What are the virtues of the Free Gardeners?

Free Gardeners cultivate Love, Wisdom, Harmony, and Truth, using these virtues to tend both their inner garden and the world around them.